全民英檢中級 GEPT Intermediate | 第 25 單元 | 情緒與感受 · Feelings & Emotions

Ten Minutes Before the Speech

上台前的十分鐘

Ten minutes before the English speech contest, Jia-hao was sitting alone behind the school auditorium, staring at his cue cards. His hands were shaking, and the anxiety in his stomach felt like a stone. 'I can't do this,' he whispered when his teacher, Ms. Huang, found him. 'Everyone will laugh when I forget a line.'

Ms. Huang sat down beside him. 'Do you remember the first time you read aloud in my class?' she asked. 'You blushed so hard that your ears turned red, and you were ashamed for a week. But you didn't stop. You came to every practice, even when the other students were discouraged by the long passages.' Jia-hao looked up. 'That was different. Nobody was watching then.' 'Nobody is watching now,' she said with a cheerful smile. 'They are listening. There is a difference.'

He was not sure he believed her, but her calm voice was a comfort. When his name was called, he walked onto the stage with more determination than confidence. The first sentence came out too fast. The second was better. By the third paragraph, he noticed a boy in the front row nodding with real curiosity, and something inside him relaxed.

He did not win. A girl from another class took first prize with a story about her grandmother's night-market stall, and Jia-hao felt a surprising admiration for her rather than envy. Backstage, Ms. Huang handed him a bottle of water. 'Still think you can't do it?' she asked. Jia-hao grinned. For the first time that day, he felt genuinely content.

重點單字 Key Vocabulary

單字	詞性	中文	例句
anxiety	*n.*	焦慮	Many students feel anxiety before a big test. 很多學生在大考前會感到焦慮。
blush	*v.*	臉紅	She blushed when the teacher praised her in front of the class. 老師在全班面前稱讚她時，她臉紅了。

ashamed	*adj.*	羞愧的；難為情的	He was ashamed of lying to his parents. 他為自己對父母說謊感到羞愧。
discourage	*v.*	使氣餒	Don't let one bad grade discourage you. 別讓一次不好的成績使你氣餒。
cheerful	*adj.*	開朗的；愉快的	The cheerful nurse made the children laugh. 那位開朗的護理師逗得孩子們大笑。
comfort	*n.*	安慰	Her kind words were a great comfort to me. 她親切的話語對我是莫大的安慰。
determination	*n.*	決心	With determination, she finished the marathon despite the pain. 憑著決心，她忍著疼痛跑完了馬拉松。
confidence	*n.*	信心	Practice gave him the confidence to speak in public. 練習讓他有信心在公開場合說話。
curiosity	*n.*	好奇心	Out of curiosity, the boy opened the old box. 出於好奇，那個男孩打開了舊箱子。
admiration	*n.*	欽佩	The firefighters earned the admiration of the whole town. 消防員贏得了全鎮的欽佩。

片語 Phrases

read aloud	朗讀	The teacher asked me to read the poem aloud. 老師要我把那首詩朗讀出來。
come out	說出；出來	The words came out before I could stop them. 我還來不及停下來，話就已經說出口了。
rather than	而不是	I would take the MRT rather than drive in the rain. 我寧願搭捷運，也不要在雨中開車。

文法與句型 Grammar

S + V + so + adj. / adv. + that + S + V

so ... that 表示「如此…以至於…」，so 後面接形容詞或副詞，that 引導結果子句。文中 You blushed so hard that your ears turned red 說明臉紅的程度和結果。

The soup was so hot that I burned my tongue.

湯太燙了，我燙到了舌頭。

with + more + N + than + N

用 with 加名詞片語描述伴隨的狀態，more A than B 表示「A 多於 B」。文中 with more determination than confidence 表示「決心多過信心」，是描寫人物心情的常見寫法。

She answered the question with more hope than certainty.

她回答問題時，希望多過把握。

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